

Report under Texas Business and Commerce Code Section 120.053

Information on YouTube's transparency reporting under Texas Business and Commerce Code §120.053

YouTube is producing transparency reports with details on its acceptable use policies and practices as part of efforts to provide greater transparency to Texan users. This report is in addition to the various reports we already produce that provide data and shed light on how and why users raise complaints, how we respond to those complaints, how we enforce our Community Guidelines and content policies, and how we comply with local laws to keep users safe.

This report outlines information about YouTube during the specified reporting period, July 1, 2024 to December 31, 2024. We expect to submit reports covering subsequent data periods as specified in Texas Business and Commerce Code §120.053.

Acceptable use policies

YouTube's [Terms of Service](#) highlights various policies that outline what is not allowed on YouTube. These policies include YouTube's [Community Guidelines](#), [Advertiser-Friendly Content Guidelines](#), [Copyright](#), and [related policies](#), which are made accessible in YouTube's [Help Center](#) and apply to all types of content on YouTube.

Implementing and enforcing YouTube policies

Each of YouTube's policies is carefully thought through so they are consistent, well-informed, and can be applied to content from around the world. New policies go through multiple rounds of testing before they go live to ensure YouTube's global team of content reviewers can apply them accurately and consistently.

YouTube relies on a combination of humans and machine learning technology to flag inappropriate content and enforce YouTube's Community Guidelines. This collaborative approach helps improve the accuracy of YouTube's models over time, as models continuously learn and adapt. In some cases, that same machine learning automatically takes an action, if there is high confidence that content is violative given information about similar or related content that has been previously removed.

Machine learning identifies potentially violative content at scale and nominates for review content that may be against YouTube Community Guidelines. Content moderators then help confirm whether the content should be removed or remain on the platform. It also means YouTube's enforcement systems can manage the sheer scale of content that is uploaded to YouTube, while still digging into the nuances that determine whether a piece of content is violative.

Community Guidelines enforcement

After a creator's first Community Guidelines violation, they will typically get a warning with no penalty to their channel. They will have the chance to take a policy training to allow the warning to expire after 90 days. Creators will also get the chance to receive a warning in another policy category. If the same policy is violated within that 90-day window, the creator's channel will be given a strike.

If the creator receives three strikes in the same 90-day period, their channel may be permanently removed from YouTube. In some cases, YouTube may terminate a channel for a single case of severe abuse, as [explained](#) in the Help Center. YouTube may also remove content for reasons other than Community Guidelines violations, such as a first-party privacy complaint or a court order. In these cases, creators will not be issued a strike.

If a creator's channel gets a strike, they will receive an email, and can have notifications sent to them through their mobile and desktop notifications. The emails and notifications received by the creator explain the action taken on their content and which of YouTube's policies the content violated. More detailed guidelines of YouTube's processes and policies on strikes are available [here](#).

YouTube also reserves the right to restrict a creator's ability to create content on YouTube at its discretion. A channel may be turned off or restricted from using any YouTube features. If this happens, users are prohibited from using, creating, or acquiring another channel to get around these restrictions. This prohibition applies as long as the restriction remains active on the YouTube channel. A violation of this restriction is considered circumvention under YouTube's [Terms of Service](#), and may result in termination of all existing YouTube channels of the user, any new channels created or acquired, and channels in which the user is repeatedly or prominently featured.

Government removal requests

Governments contact Google, including YouTube, with content removal requests for a number of reasons. Government bodies may claim that content violates a local law, and include court orders that are often not directed at Google, including YouTube, with their requests. More information on government requests to remove content is available on the Google Transparency Report website [here](#).

Copyright enforcement

YouTube offers a suite of copyright management tools that gives rightsholders control of their copyrighted material on YouTube. These tools have allowed creativity to thrive, while giving creators and artists the tools and resources needed to manage their content online. The Copyright Transparency Report shares information about the copyright enforcement efforts on YouTube. More information on copyright enforcement is available on the Google Transparency Report website [here](#).

Coordinated influence campaigns

Google's Threat Analysis Group (TAG) and Trust & Safety Team work to monitor malicious actors around the globe, disable their accounts, and remove the content that they post, including but not limited to coordinated information operations.

One of TAG's missions is to understand and disrupt coordinated information operations threat actors. TAG's work enables Google teams to make enforcement decisions backed by rigorous analysis. TAG's investigations do not focus on making judgments about the content on Google platforms, but rather examining technical signals, heuristics, and behavioral patterns to make an assessment that activity is coordinated inauthentic behavior.

TAG regularly publishes its TAG Bulletin, updated quarterly [here](#), which provides updates around coordinated influence operation campaigns terminated on Google's platforms, as well as additional periodic blog posts. In the Bulletin, TAG often notes when findings are similar to or supported by those reported by other platforms.

The publicly available H2 2024 TAG Bulletins (July 1, 2024 to December 31, 2024) show **81,773** YouTube channels across **57** separate actions were involved in Coordinated Influence Operation Campaigns. Industry partners supported **two** of those separate actions by providing leads.

Monetization policies

If a Creator has turned on ads monetization for a video but our reviewers and automated systems identify that the video does not comply with our Advertiser-Friendly Content Guidelines, the video will have limited or no ads appear against it. However, if Creators believe that their video is still suitable for all brands, they can request human review of that video. More on our monetization policies [here](#).

YouTube video demonetizations due to violations of monetization policies

4,615,183

Alerting and actioning under our Community Guidelines policies

The following is information on alerting and actioning globally under Community Guidelines policies between July 1, 2024 and December 31, 2024.

Removed, appealed, and reinstated videos

YouTube relies on teams around the world to review flagged videos and remove content that violates our Community Guidelines; restrict videos (e.g., age-restrict content that may not be appropriate for all audiences); or leave the content live when it doesn't violate our guidelines.

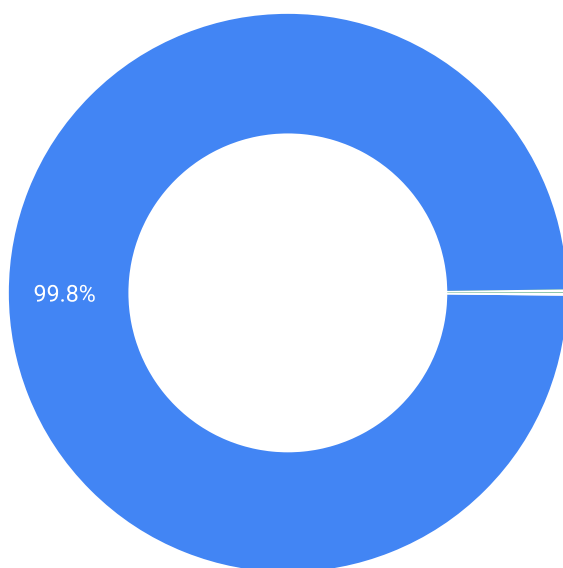
The total number of videos removed by YouTube for violating its Community Guidelines during the reporting period was **18,573,169**.

Creators have 30 days to submit an appeal after the video's removal, so this number also includes appeals for videos removed during a previous time period but appealed in the current reporting period. The number of appeals YouTube received for videos removed due to a Community Guidelines violation during the reporting period was **851,851**. The number of videos YouTube reinstated due to an appeal after being removed for a Community Guidelines violation during the reporting period was **118,673**. Note that a reinstatement counted here may be in response to an appeal or video removal that occurred in a previous time period.

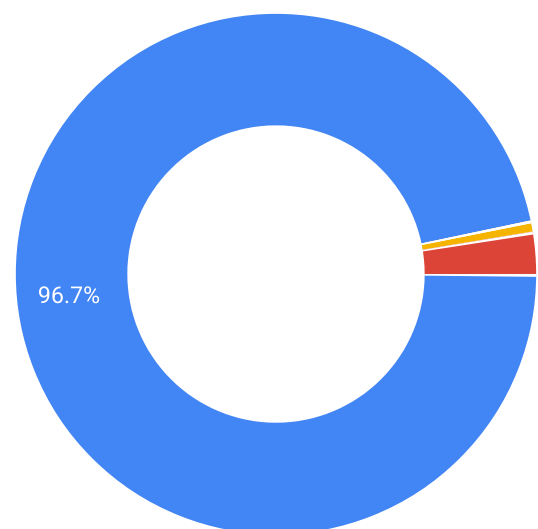
Human flags by flagger type

In addition to our automated flagging systems, [Priority Flaggers](#) and our broader community of users play an important role in flagging content. Flagged content will remain live when it doesn't violate our Community Guidelines. A single video may be flagged multiple times and for different reasons. Flags from human detection can come from a user or a member of YouTube's Priority Flagger program. Priority Flagger program members include NGOs and government agencies that are particularly effective at notifying YouTube of content that violates our Community Guidelines.

The bottom left chart shows the breakdown of flags that come from different types of human flaggers. The bottom right chart shows the volume of all videos removed by YouTube for violating Community Guidelines policies, by source of first detection (automated flagging or human detection).



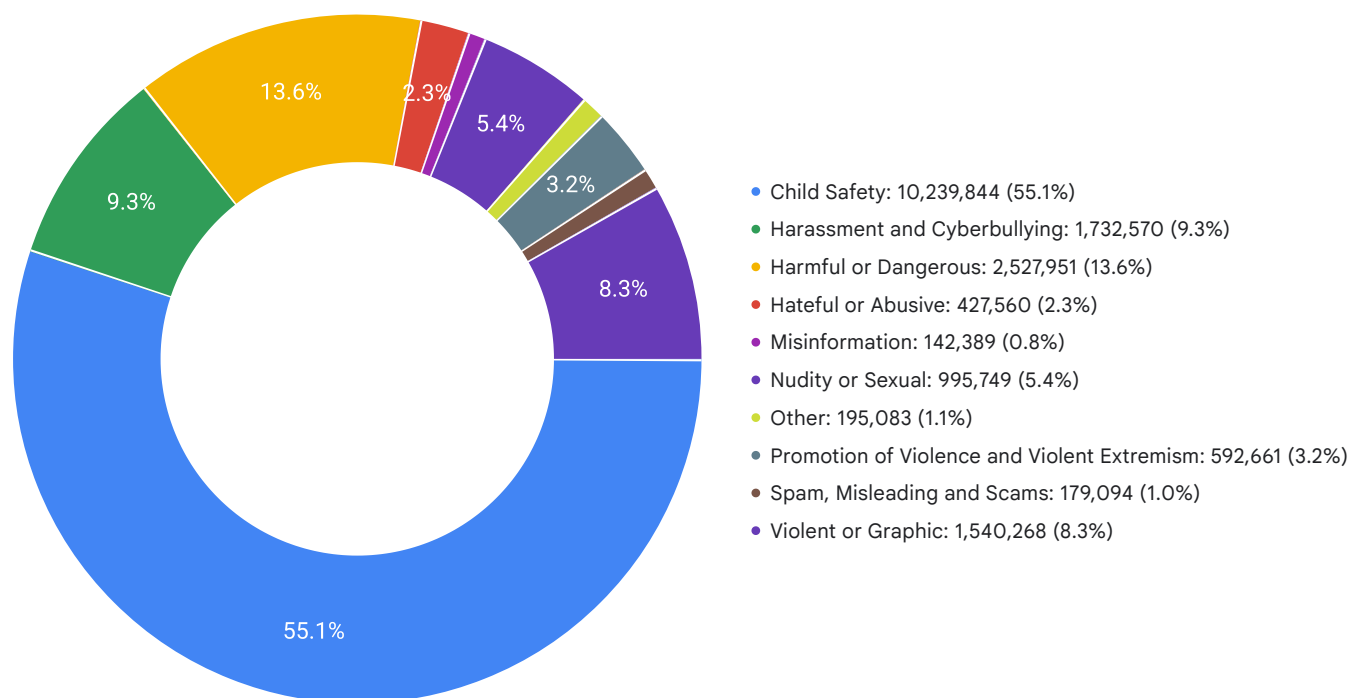
- User: 168,714,599 (99.8%)
- Organization: 325,627 (0.2%)
- Government: 38 (0.0%)



- Automation detection first flag: 17,956,890 (96.7%)
- Government: 2 (0.0%)
- Organization: 124,133 (0.7%)
- User: 492,144 (2.6%)

Video removals by reason and by country

The chart below shows the volume of videos removed by YouTube, by the reason a video was removed. These removal reasons correspond to YouTube's [Community Guidelines](#). Reviewers evaluate flagged videos against all of our Community Guidelines and policies, regardless of the reason the video was originally flagged.



The table below shows the number of videos removed by YouTube, by the country/region of upload. This data is based on the uploader's IP address at the time the video was uploaded. The IP address usually corresponds with where an uploader is geolocated, unless they are using a virtual private network (VPN) or proxy server. YouTube's Community Guidelines are enforced consistently across the globe, regardless of where the content is uploaded. When content is removed for violating our guidelines, it is removed globally.

Rank	Country	Value
1	India	5 143 716
2	Brazil	1 912 364
3	United States	1 779 313
4	Russia	1 237 916
5	Indonesia	1 025 270
6	Bangladesh	515 573
7	Pakistan	435 253
8	Philippines	335 195
9	Turkey	304 902
10	Mexico	249 004
11	Great Britain	225 658
12	Vietnam	224 171
13	Germany	219 404
14	Ivory Coast	184 772
15	Iraq	183 766

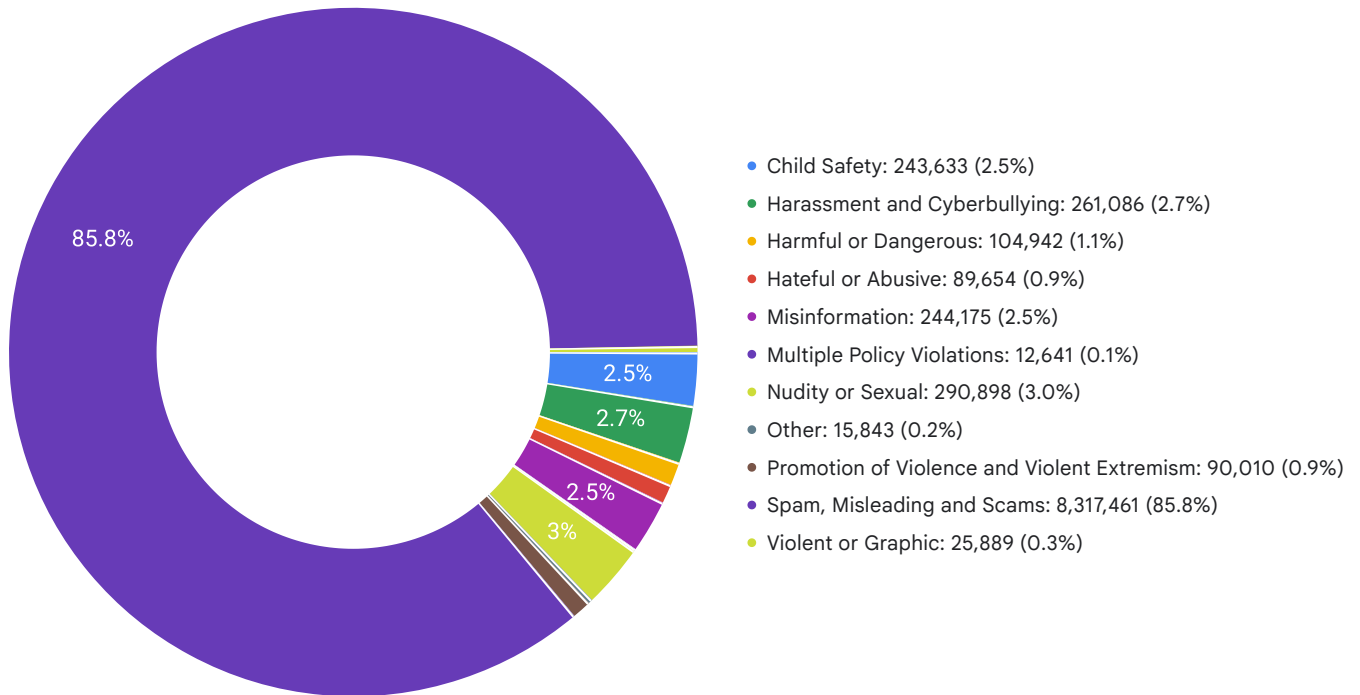
Rank	Country	Value
16	Ukraine	177 823
17	Argentina	174 978
18	Thailand	167 399
19	Kazakhstan	146 828
20	France	131 319
21	Colombia	127 001
22	Nepal	120 820
23	Spain	119 495
24	Morocco	116 842
25	Malaysia	116 544
26	Canada	110 972
27	Venezuela	108 840
28	Saudi Arabia	100 901
29	Japan	100 499
30	Italy	98 660

Channels removed

A YouTube channel is terminated if it accrues three [Community Guidelines strikes](#) in 90 days, has a single case of severe abuse (such as predatory behavior), or is determined to be wholly dedicated to violating our guidelines (as is often the case with spam accounts). When a channel is terminated, all of its videos are removed.

The total number of channels removed by YouTube for violating its Community Guidelines during the reporting period was **9,696,232**.

The chart below shows the volume of channels removed by YouTube, by the reason a channel was removed. The majority of channel terminations are a result of accounts being dedicated to spam or adult sexual content in violation of our guidelines. When we terminate a channel for receiving three [Community Guidelines strikes](#) for violating several different policies within a three month period, we categorize it under a separate label - "Multiple policy violations" - because these accounts were not wholly dedicated to one policy violation.



Additional restrictions on content

Sometimes content doesn't violate our Community Guidelines, but it may be incompatible with YouTube's Terms of Service or not appropriate for viewers under 18. In these cases, we may place an age-restriction on the video. More on age-restricted content [here](#).

Age restrictions applied

3,765,377